

ENTRY PRINCIPLE

Earn the right to prioritize.

The first deliverable is not a grand roadmap. It is a trusted, evidence-backed way to make the next set of AI decisions better across business, technical, governance, adoption, and value partners.

Read the work. Charter the decisions. Run controlled proof.

Every phase leaves a usable operating mechanism behind, even when an opportunity is held or stopped.

NON-NEGOTIABLES

Human authority explicit

Evidence before momentum

Adoption owned

Learning returns to portfolio

DAYS 1-30 · READ THE WORK

1-30

LISTEN, MAP, ESTABLISH TRUST

Understand the portfolio and the operating system around it.

- Map current AI initiatives, business objectives, sponsors, technical teams, governance touchpoints, and operating owners.
- Observe representative workflows with the people closest to the work.
- Document systems, authoritative data, integrations, decision rights, exception paths, and current measures.
- Identify where opportunities stall: problem definition, evidence, proof design, governance, integration, adoption, ownership, or value capture.
- Review existing change, training, communications, and measurement practices.
- Establish a concise weekly decision cadence with the Director of AI and key HPO partners.

OUTPUTS BY DAY 30

Portfolio inventory

One view of active, proposed, held, and stopped opportunities with owners and current decision state.

Stakeholder and authority map

Who sponsors, performs, governs, integrates, trains, measures, and retains consequential judgment.

Friction and evidence map

Where work slows, what evidence exists, and which missing conditions prevent reliable proof.

MEASURES OF A STRONG FIRST MONTH

Shared language improves; hidden ownership and evidence gaps become visible; stakeholders recognize their reality in the map; and the AI team can explain why each major opportunity is advancing, bounded, held, or stopped.

CONVERT INTEREST INTO COMPARABLE DECISIONS

Install opportunity discipline before proof capacity is consumed.

01	02	03	04	05
Workflow friction	Evidence readiness	Human authority	Adoption ownership	Value evidence

CORE ACTIONS

- Co-design one concise opportunity charter with business, technical, governance, adoption, and value partners.
- Define proof questions, not just solution features.
- Make source authority, data quality, privacy, security, and integration constraints visible early.
- Document the qualified human decisions and escalation paths that remain non-delegable.
- Define the operating owner, training path, communications, user feedback, and exception-handling responsibilities.
- Set measurement categories and evidence collection before the proof begins.
- Create explicit advance, bounded-assist, hold, human-led, and stop dispositions.
- Use portfolio reviews to compare opportunities on decision quality rather than unsupported scores.

OPERATING CADENCE

Weekly opportunity review Resolve missing evidence, ownership, authority, and next decisions.	Biweekly proof review Examine workflow fit, model behavior, risk, user feedback, and measurement integrity.	Monthly portfolio review Rebalance capacity, stop weak work, and identify reusable components or interventions.
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OUTPUTS BY DAY 60

- Agreed opportunity-charter template and review cadence.
- Comparable charters for the highest-priority opportunities.
- One or two controlled-proof briefs with explicit business problem, evidence, authority, adoption, measures, and stop criteria.
- Initial reusable-pattern register: data/evidence components, governance controls, training interventions, integration patterns, and measurement methods.

MEASURES OF A STRONG SECOND MONTH

Fewer vague use cases reach technical teams; governance and adoption partners enter earlier; proof designs have unambiguous measures and human authority; and portfolio reviews can stop or hold work without treating that as failure.

PROVE THE OPERATING INTERVENTION

Test workflow fit, authority, adoption, and evidence - not only model output.

CORE ACTIONS

61-90

- Launch one or two bounded proofs where the opportunity charter supports action.
- Instrument the current workflow and proof workflow with the same comparison units.
- Capture user behavior, trust, exception patterns, data/evidence failures, and operating workarounds.
- Conduct structured reviews with frontline users, business owners, technical teams, and governance partners.
- Resolve to scale, continue bounded proof, hold for readiness, remain human-led, or stop.
- Return reusable learning to the portfolio and update the opportunity-charter standard.

BALANCED EVIDENCE CATEGORIES

Operating outcome

Cycle time, preparation effort, rework, exception age, completeness, or another workflow-specific unit.

Quality and trust

Error, override, escalation, source provenance, policy adherence, user confidence, and affected-person experience.

Adoption and learning

Use in the intended workflow, training effectiveness, repeat use, exception resolution, and reusable patterns.

OUTPUTS BY DAY 90

- Controlled-proof results with explicit assumptions and evidence boundaries.
- Scale / continue / hold / human-led / stop recommendations.
- Updated portfolio with capacity and value implications.
- Reusable-pattern register and next-quarter learning agenda.
- Executive brief showing what changed in work, what remained human, what evidence was captured, and what decision follows.

PRIMARY RISKS AND COUNTERMEASURES

Risk: proof theater

Countermeasure: require a workflow owner, comparison unit, adoption plan, and evidence collection before launch.

Risk: late governance surprise

Countermeasure: make authority, data, privacy, legal, security, and policy conditions charter inputs.

Risk: adoption treated as communications

Countermeasure: define changed work, exception handling, coaching, and accountable operating ownership.

Risk: weak work consumes capacity

Countermeasure: normalize hold and stop decisions as valuable portfolio management.

Day-90 test

Can HPO leaders explain, with evidence, why the selected opportunities deserve the next increment of capacity - and why others do not?